

Reting Rinpoche

Monks all over Tibet were on the lookout for the next Dalai Lama. Reting Rinpoche (say: RIHN-poh-CHAY), who was acting as Tibet's temporary leader, went to look for signs himself. He journeyed to a lake that was thought to have special powers. For centuries, Tibetans had visited the lake hoping to see inspiring visions. While there, Reting Rinpoche closed his eyes and thought deeply. When he opened his eyes, he saw three Tibetan letters rise out of the water—*Ah*, *Ka*, and *Ma*. He also saw a vision of a three-story monastery with a blue-and-gold roof and a small house on a hill. He hoped that these signs would lead him to the next Dalai Lama.

In late 1936, search parties made up of monks and government members set out from Lhasa and headed east.

One group traveled to the province of Amdo, because *Ah* was one of the letters Reting Rinpoche saw on the lake. It was a difficult trek on horseback over rough land and through harsh snow.